

Service in a Snap: Tent Maintenance & Inventory

Estimated Time: 60–90 Minutes

Who: Designated Scout (e.g., Patrol Quartermaster) or Adult Leader.

When: After every campout or semi-annually during gear turnover.

Impact: Prevents the growth of destructive mold and mildew and ensures the Troop has complete, functional shelters ready for the next adventure.

Requirements: Can fulfill leadership duties for the Quartermaster position. ST21 knot requirements.

Reference:

- [Taking care of Troop Gear](#)
- [Tent Inventory Sheet](#)
- Service in a Snap (Troop Google Drive)

Your Mission

Inspect, clean, and inventory a Troop tent to ensure it is 100% dry, free of debris, and has all needed pieces. All items must be properly labeled and any minor damage repaired using the troop's repair kit to make sure the tent is ready for its next outing.

Preparation

1. **Pick up the Gear:** Check out a tent from the Troop Quartermaster. Tents are stored in the troop equipment closet.
2. **Gather Supplies:** Soap and water solution, sponges, cleaning rags, paint markers (for labeling), and the **Tent Repair Kit** (Stored with tents in the Closet).

3. **Set up Space:** Find a clean, flat surface, preferably outdoors in a sunny, breezy location to facilitate thorough drying.

Step-by-Step Instructions

- **Step 1: Clean Out & Dry** – Unpack the tent and shake out any mud, grass, or leaves. If mud is present, allow it to dry before sweeping it out. Wipe down surfaces with soap and water if necessary. Ensure the tent, fly, and footprint are **100% dry** before repacking to prevent mold.
- **Step 2: Labelling** – Use a paint marker to re-label or add markings to the tent bag, pole bag, stake bag, and the tent itself using the **YY-Tent#** format (e.g., **26-1** for tent number 1 in the year 2026).
- **Step 3: Inventory** – Use the checklist below to confirm all required components are present.
- **Step 4: Quality Check** – Inspect the tent body and fly for holes or tears. Ensure all **6 guy lines** are securely attached to the tent or fly. Check zippers for smooth operation and inspect poles for cracks or failed shock cords.
- **Step 5: Restock & Repair** – Use the **Tent Repair Kit** to patch any small holes. If stakes are missing, pull replacements from the tent repair kit.
- **Step 6: Organize** – Pack all components into their respective bags. Fold the tent, footprint and fly lengthwise, roll poles into tent tightly to remove air and pack into the tent bag.
- **Step 7: Report** – Submit the completed inventory checklist and report any major damage (e.g., failed poles or large tears) to Troop Quartermaster and Equipment Coordinator.

Inventory

Confirm the tent kit contains the following required quantities.

Item Description	Required Qty	Actual Qty	Status / Notes
Tent Body	1		
Rain Fly	1		

Item Description	Required Qty	Actual Qty	Status / Notes
Tarp / Footprint	1		
Main Tent Poles	2		
Tent Stakes	12		
Guy Lines (Attached)	6		
Tent Stuff Sack	1		
Pole Bag	1		
Stake Bag	1		

Notes:

Parent/Scout Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Troop Quartermaster: _____ **Date:** _____

Equipment Coordinator: _____ **Date:** _____